# ProjectDesk

## User Manual

Version 2.3.0
November 2026

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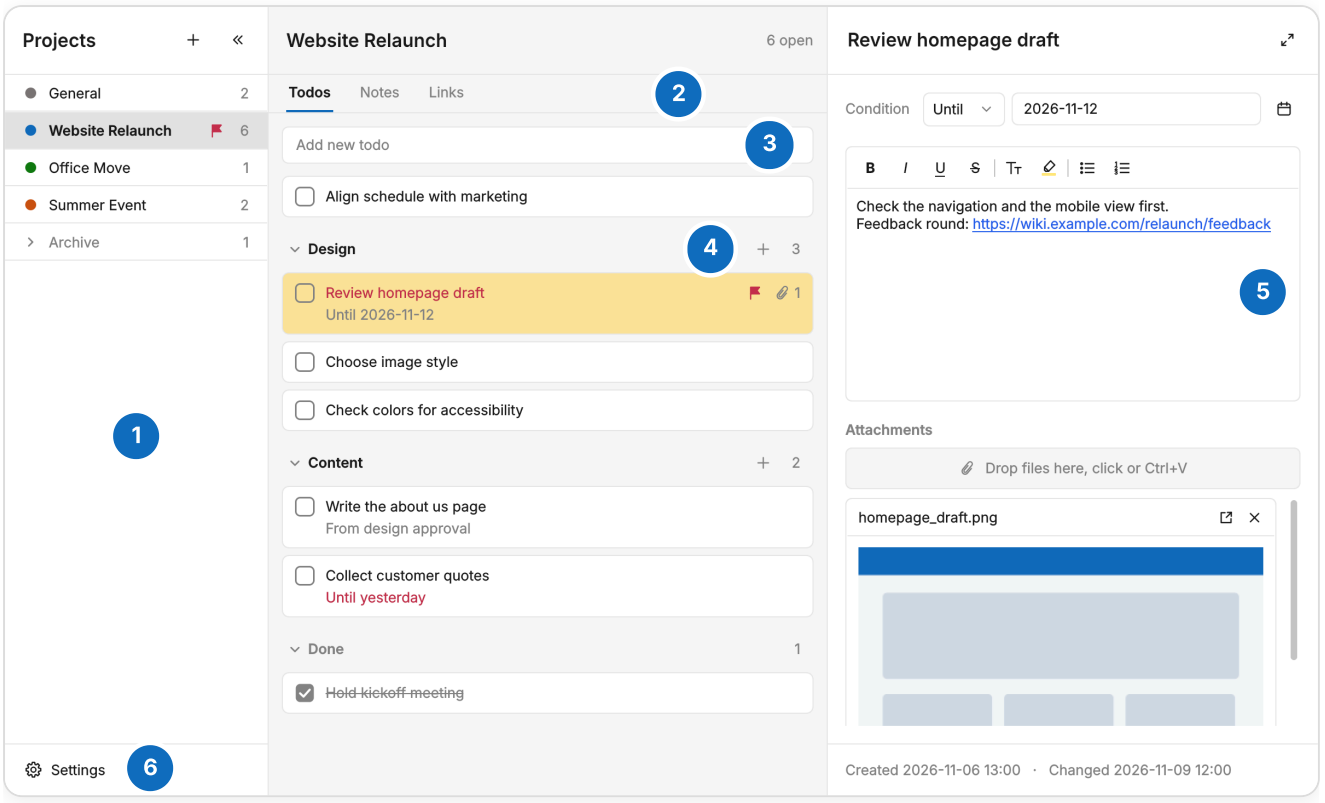
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# The Main Window

ProjectDesk keeps everything that belongs to a project in one place: todos, notes and links. The window has three columns: your projects on the left, the entries of the open project in the middle and the details of the selected entry on the right.




The main window with the todos of a project

1. **Projects**: the fixed project **General**, your projects and the archive. The number shows the open todos, a red flag shows flagged todos.
2. **Tabs**: every project has todos, notes and links. Tabs you do not need can be hidden in the settings.
3. **Input field**: type and press `Enter` to add a new entry.
4. **Group**: entries can be sorted into groups. The **+** adds an entry directly to the group.
5. **Details** of the selected entry: text, attachments, fields and dates. The icon at the top right enlarges this column to the whole window.
6. **Settings**: mode, language, zoom, tabs, storage location and backups.

> **Good to know.** Almost every action is in the right-click menu. Rename anything with a double-click. Changes are saved automatically, and `Ctrl` + `Z` undoes every change.

# Installation and First Start

## Install

1. Download **ProjectDesk_Setup.exe** from the Releases page of the ProjectDesk repository.
2. Run it. No administrator rights are needed.
3. If Windows shows a SmartScreen warning, click **More info** and then **Run anyway**.

## First start

ProjectDesk asks for a folder in which all data is stored. A folder in your OneDrive is a good choice because OneDrive backs it up automatically. The folder can be changed later (see **Storage Location**).

## Update

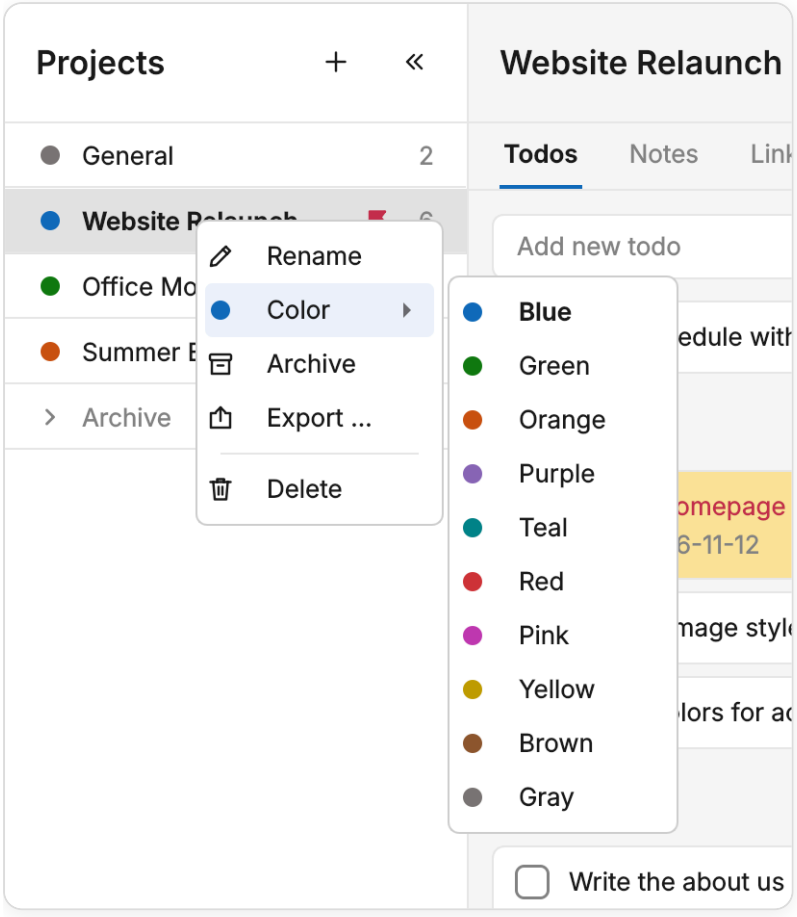
When a new version is available, ProjectDesk shows a blue dot on **Settings** (see **Settings**). Download the new setup and run it over the installed version. Your data and settings are kept. An existing installation of the predecessor **ToDo** is updated to ProjectDesk the same way.

Only one ProjectDesk window runs at a time. Starting it again brings the open window to the front.

## Projects

The project **General** is always at the top. Use it for everything that does not belong to a project.

- **New project**: click **+** next to **Projects**, or right-click the free space below the projects. Type the name and press `Enter`.
- **Rename**: double-click the project, or right-click and choose **Rename**.
- **Color**: right-click and choose a color for the dot.
- **Order**: drag a project up or down.
- **Archive**: right-click and choose **Archive**, or drag the project onto the **Archive** row. A click on **Archive** shows the archived projects. Right-click one and choose **Restore** to bring it back.
- **Delete**: right-click and choose **Delete**, or press `Delete`. ProjectDesk asks before deleting.
- **More space**: the button **«** collapses the project column to a narrow strip, **»** opens it again.




Right-click menu of a project with the colors

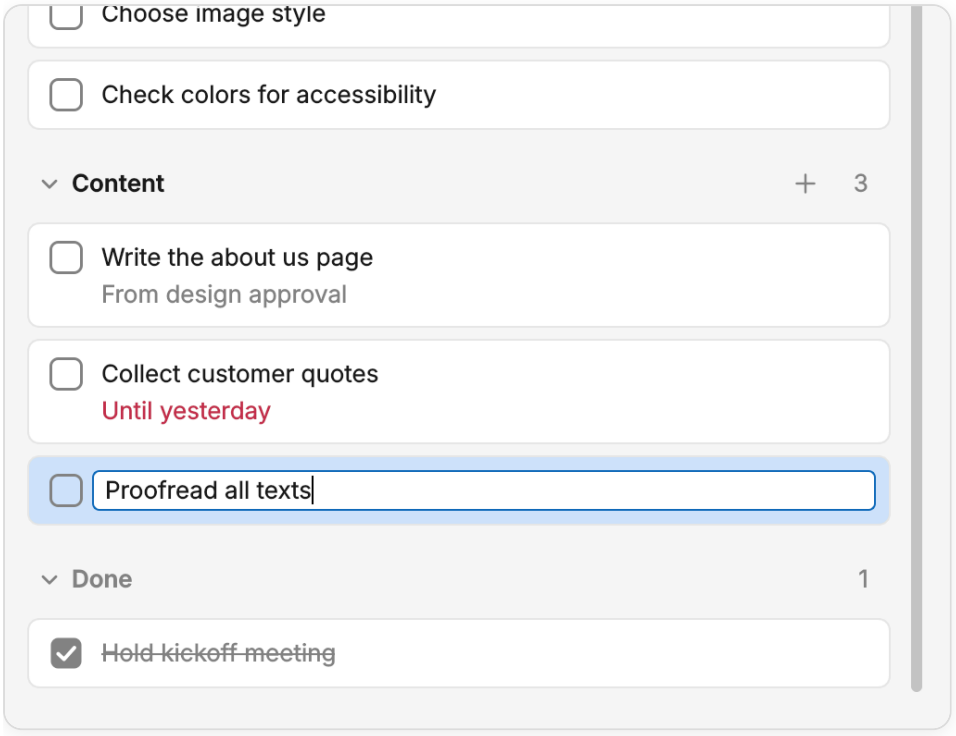
## Tabs and Groups

Every project has the tabs **Todos**, **Notes** and **Links**. Each tab has its own groups, for example **Design** and **Content** for todos. Groups are optional, entries without a group are shown at the top.

- **New group**: right-click the free space in the list and choose **New group**.
- **Collapse or expand**: click the group header.
- **Rename**: double-click the group header.
- **Order**: drag the group header up or down.
- **Delete**: right-click the header and choose **Delete**. The entries stay, they are shown without a group.

### Adding entries to a group

Click the **+** on the group header and type the name. `Enter` saves it and opens the next entry, so several entries can be typed one after another. `Esc` ends. In the notes tab, `Enter` continues in the text of the new note.



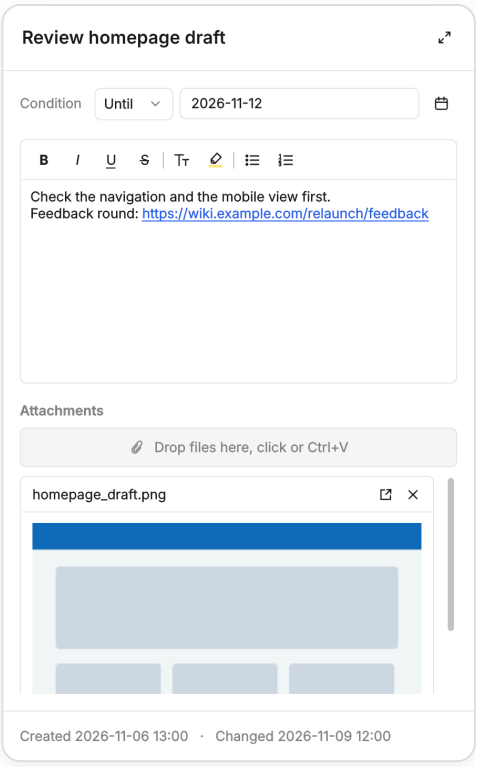

A new todo is typed directly into the group Content

### Moving entries

Drag an entry to another place, into another group or onto a collapsed group header. Dropping it onto a project on the left moves it into that project.

# Todos

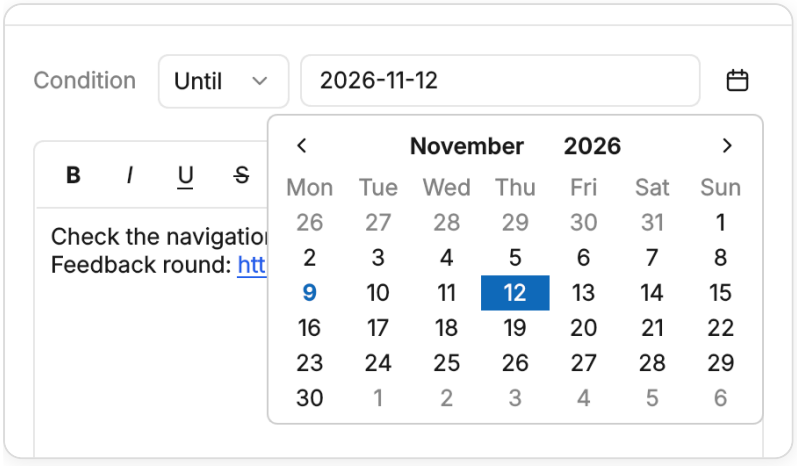
- **Add**: type into **Add new todo** and press Enter.
- **Done**: click the checkbox. The todo moves to the section **Done** at the end of the list and its flag is removed. Clicking the checkbox again reopens it.
- **Flag**: right-click an open todo and choose **Flag** for important todos. They get a yellow background and the project shows a red flag. A click on the flag removes it.
- **Rename**: double-click the todo in the list, or edit the title on the right.




Details of a todo with description and attachment

## Condition

A todo can have a condition: **Until** for a deadline or **From** for the earliest start. Choose the kind next to **Condition**, then type a date like 14.11. or 2026-11-14, or any text like "design approval". The calendar icon picks a date. **None** removes the condition.




A deadline picked in the calendar

The condition is shown below the title of the todo. A deadline that is today or past is red, a start date that is reached is blue.

## Description

Descriptions, notes and the notes of links share the same toolbar:



The toolbar for formatting text

- **Bold** (Ctrl + B), *italic* (Ctrl + I), underline (Ctrl + U) and ~~strikethrough~~.
- **Font size**: Small, Normal, Large or Extra large, for example for headings. The sizes grow and shrink with the zoom.

- **Highlight**: marks the selected text in yellow.
- **Bullet list** and **Numbered list**. Tab moves a list line one level in, Shift+Tab one level out. A dash followed by a space at the start of a line starts a bullet list.

Web addresses and network paths become links automatically, a click opens them.

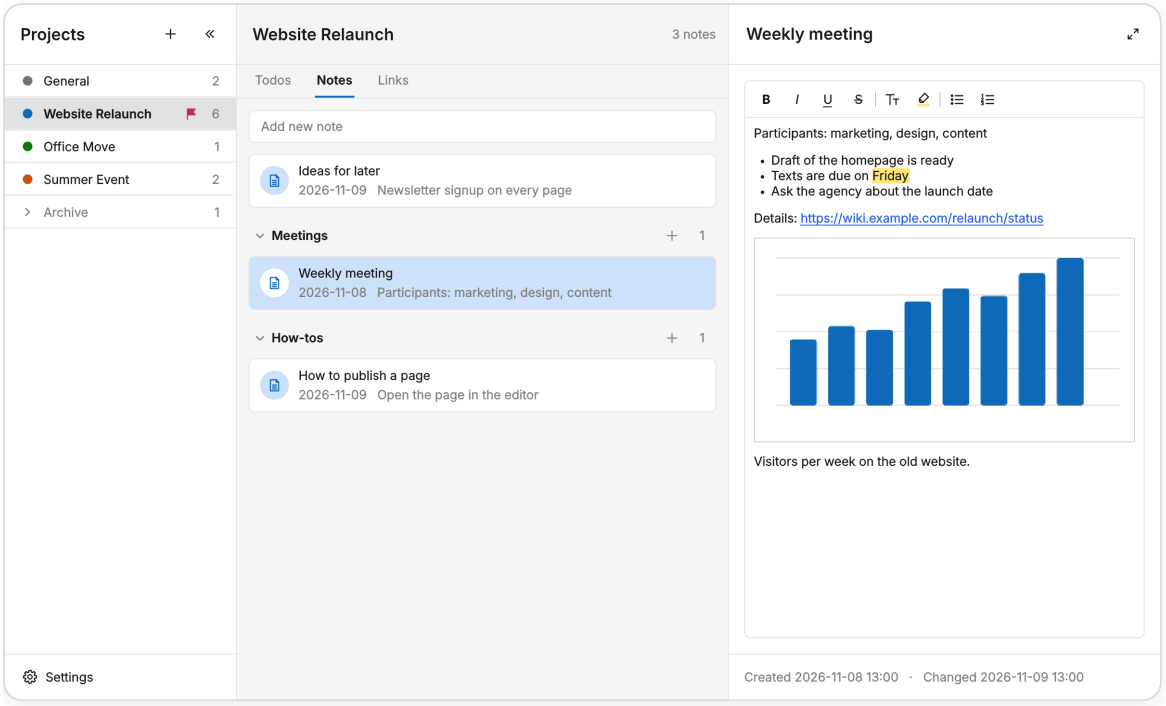
### Attachments

Drop files onto **Drop files here, click or Ctrl+V**, click it to choose files, or paste files and screenshots with Ctrl+V. Images and PDF files show a preview. The icons next to the file name open it with the default program or remove it.

> **Note.** Attachments are copied into the storage folder. The original file can be moved or deleted afterwards.

# Notes

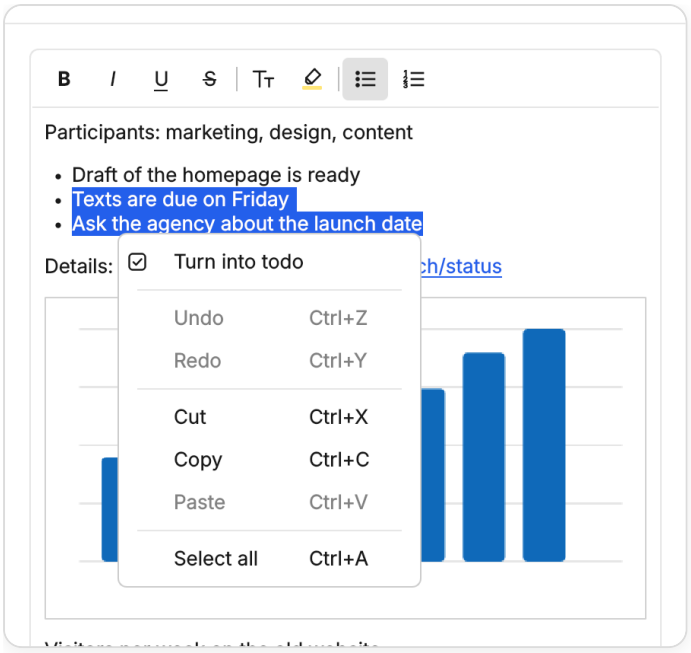
- **Add**: type a title into **Add new note** and press Enter. Enter in the empty field creates a note named with today's date.
- **Text**: the same formatting as todo descriptions, including font sizes, highlight, lists and clickable links.
- **Images**: paste screenshots with Ctrl + V. Every image gets a line of its own and fits the width of the note. A double-click shows it large.
- **PDF**: right-click the note in the list and choose **Export as PDF**.




A note with bullet list, link and image

### Turning lines into todos

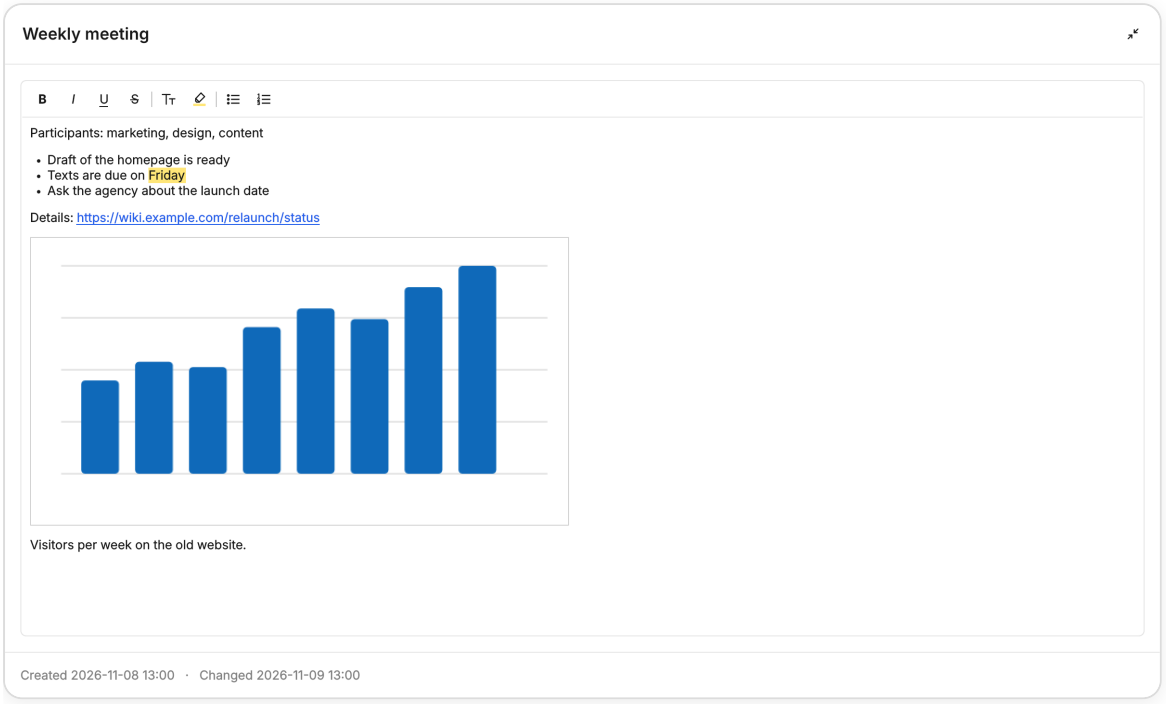
Select one or more lines, or place the cursor in a line, right-click and choose **Turn into todo**. The lines become todos of the same project and get a check mark in the note, so they are not taken over twice.




Turn into todo in the right-click menu of a note

## Writing with more space

The icon at the top right of the right column enlarges it to the whole window, for example for long notes. The same icon brings back the normal view.

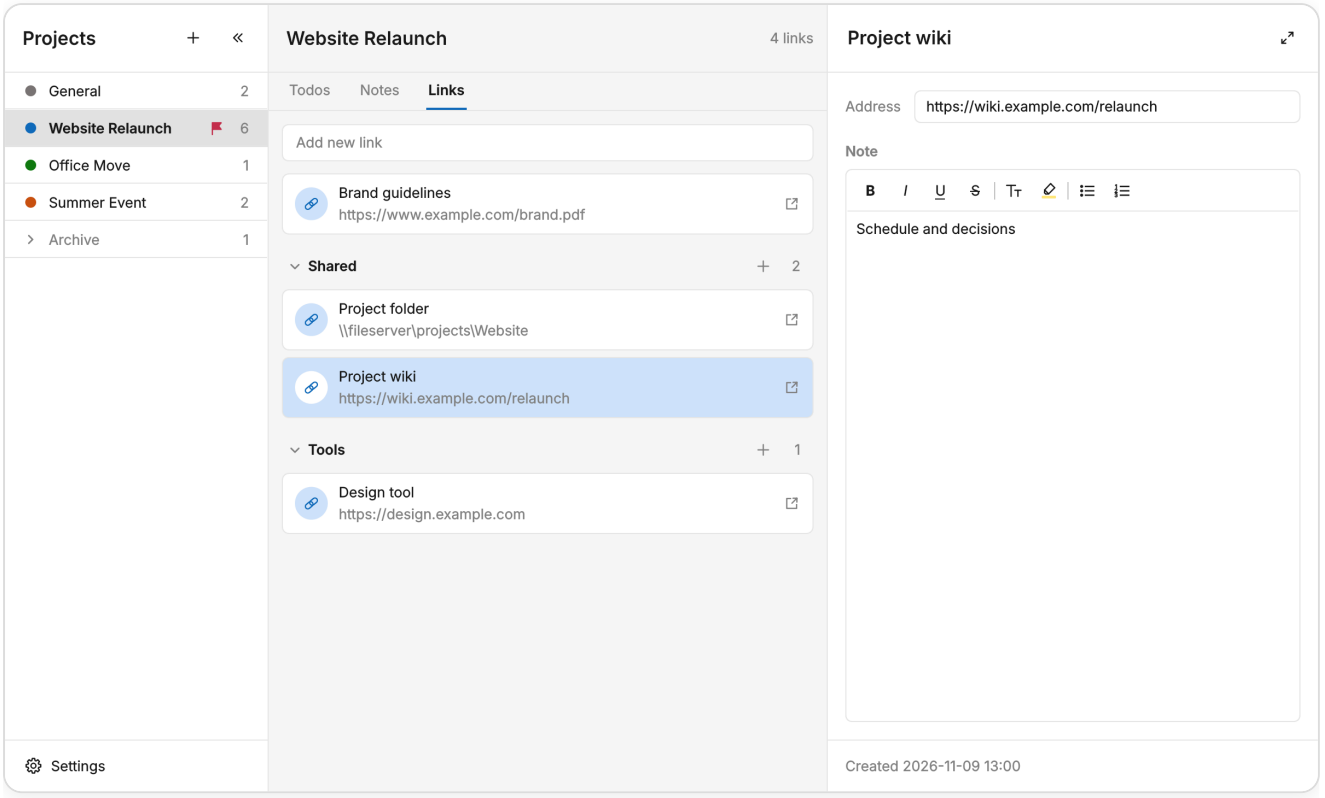



A note across the whole window

# Links

Links collect the places that belong to a project: web pages, shared files, folders on network drives and tools.

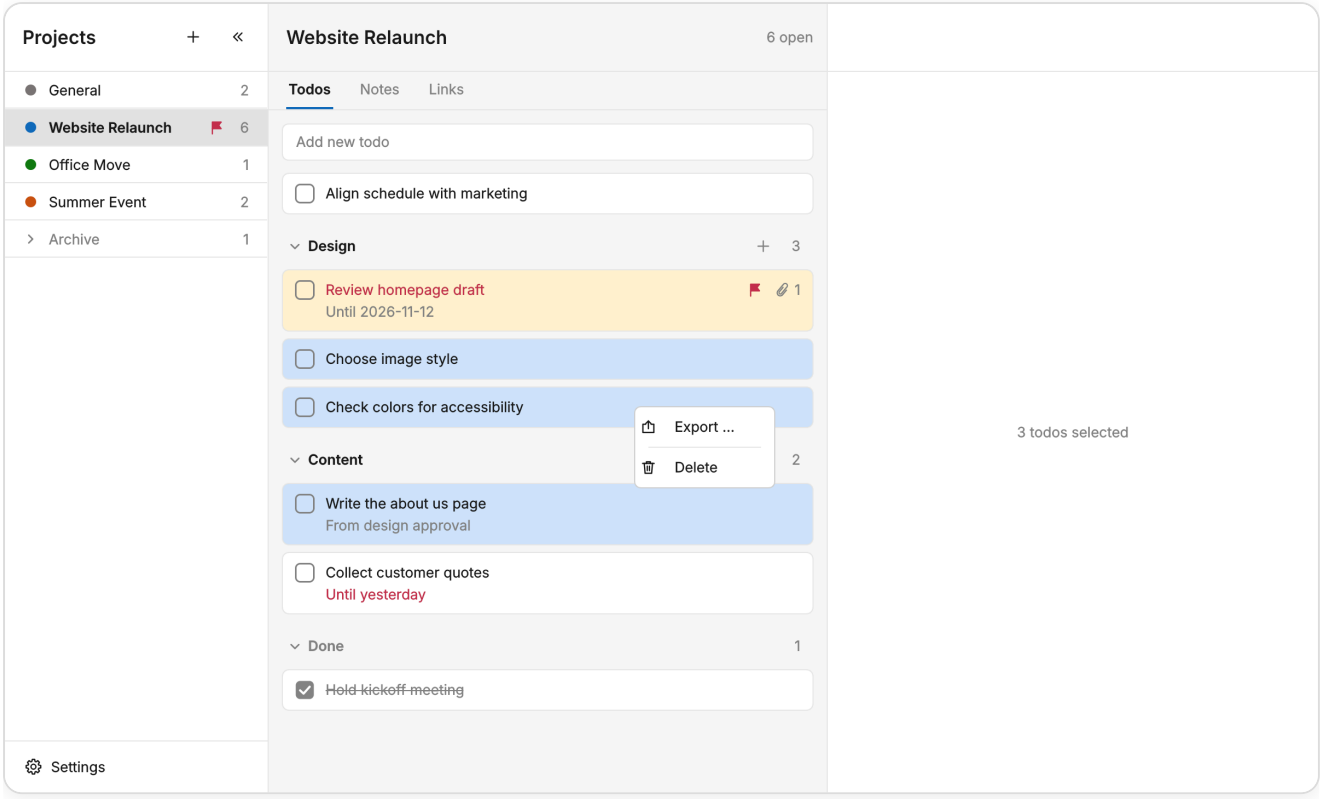
- **Add**: paste an address into **Add new link** and press Enter. The name is taken from the address and can be changed. If you type a name instead, enter the address on the right.
- Web addresses, **www.** addresses, network paths like **\\server\share** and local paths like **C:\Tools** are supported.
- **Open**: click the icon on the right of the link, or right-click and choose **Open**. Web pages open in the browser, folders in the Explorer and files with their program. **Copy address** copies the address to the clipboard.
- The field **Note** holds additional information.




Links in groups with address and note

## Selecting Several Entries

- Ctrl +click adds an entry to the selection or removes it.
- Shift +click selects all entries between the selected one and the clicked one.
- Ctrl + A selects all entries of the tab, Esc clears the selection.
- **Move**: drag one of the selected entries. All selected entries move along, into a group or onto a project.
- **Export or delete**: right-click one of the selected entries. Delete deletes the selection after a question.




Three selected todos with their right-click menu

## Undo and Redo

Ctrl + Z undoes the last change, Ctrl + Y or Ctrl + Shift + Z redoes it. This works for everything: deleting, moving, renaming, checking off, imports and restored backups. Deleted attachments and images come back as well.

While you are typing in a text field, Ctrl + Z first undoes the typing in that field. The last 50 changes can be undone. When ProjectDesk is closed, the undo history is cleared, the backups remain.

# Sharing with Colleagues

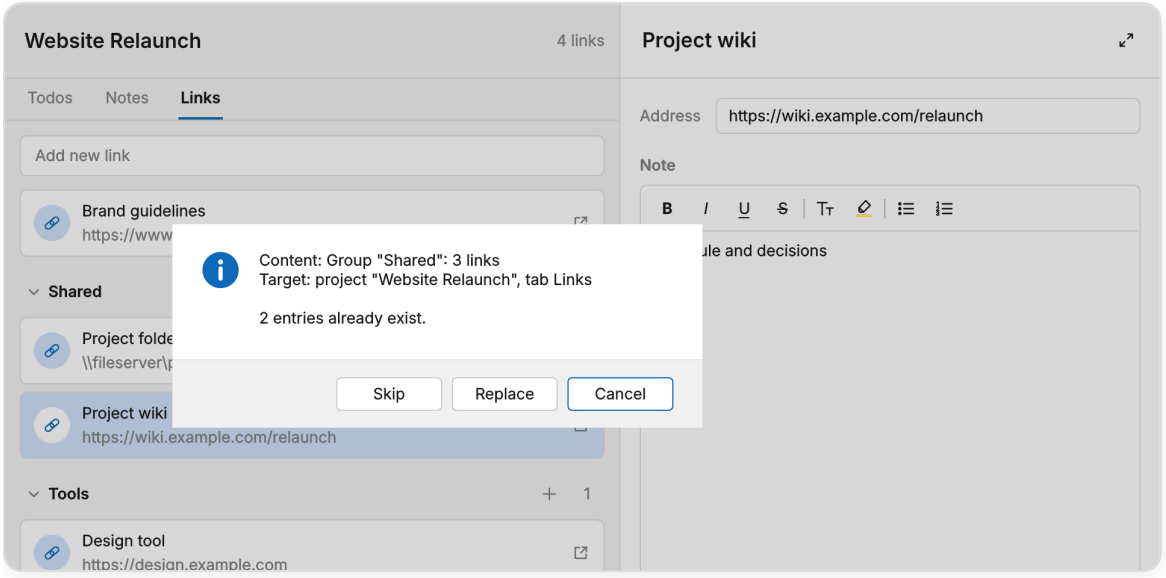
### Export

Right-click an entry, a group, a project or several selected entries and choose **Export ...**. ProjectDesk creates a **.pdesk** file that contains everything including attachments and images. Send it by email, Teams or a shared drive.

### Import

- Double-click the **.pdesk** file in the Explorer,
- drop it onto the ProjectDesk window, or
- right-click the free space in a list or in the project column and choose **Import ...**.

Before anything changes, ProjectDesk shows what the file contains and where it goes. Entries and groups go into the open project, always into the matching tab. A project is added as a new project. A hidden tab is shown again when entries are imported into it.

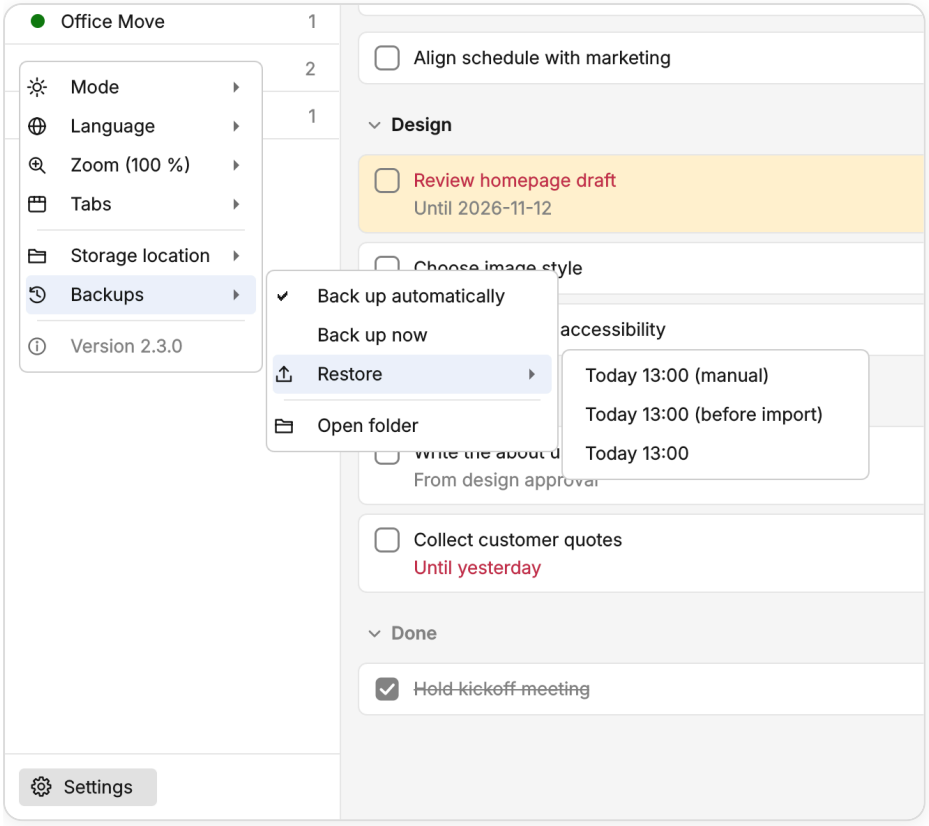



The import asks what to do with entries that already exist

If entries already exist, choose **Skip** to keep yours or **Replace** to take over the imported version. Entries count as existing if they are the same entry or links with the same address. A backup is made before every import, and <kbd>Ctrl</kbd> + <kbd>Z</kbd> undoes it.

# Backups

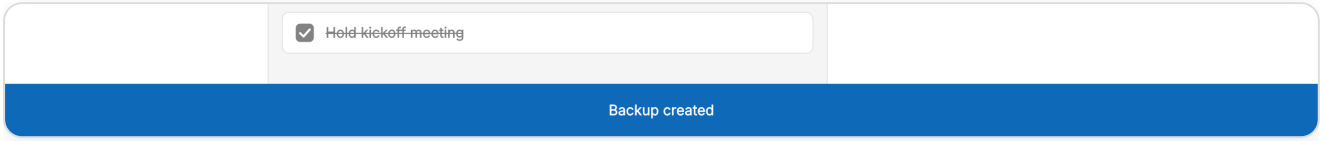
ProjectDesk backs up your data automatically: once a day, and additionally before every import, before moving the data and before restoring a backup. The 30 newest backups are kept.




Settings, Backups, Restore

- **Back up automatically**: switches the automatic backup on or off. It is on by default.
- **Back up now**: creates a backup immediately.
- **Restore**: lists all backups with date and reason. Choosing one asks first and backs up the current state before restoring, so nothing gets lost. Ctrl + Z undoes the restore.
- **Open folder**: shows the backup files in the Explorer.

Short confirmations like **Backup created** appear in a blue bar at the bottom of the window.




Confirmation at the bottom of the window

## Storage Location

**Settings**, **Storage location** shows the folder with your data.

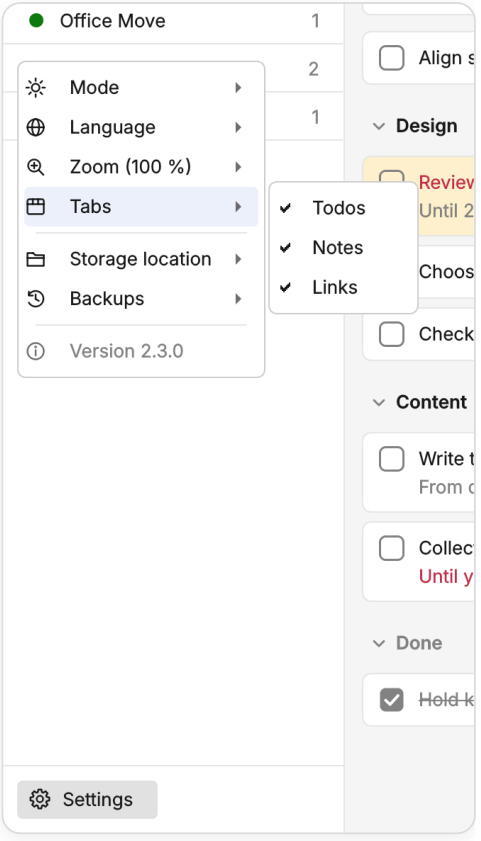
- **Open in Explorer**: opens the folder.
- **Move data ...**: moves all data, attachments, images and backups to a new, empty folder. The copy is checked before the old files are removed.
- **Open other storage location ...**: switches to a folder that already contains ProjectDesk data, for example after setting up a new computer.

> **Important.** A storage folder should only be used by one ProjectDesk at a time. To share content with colleagues, use export and import.

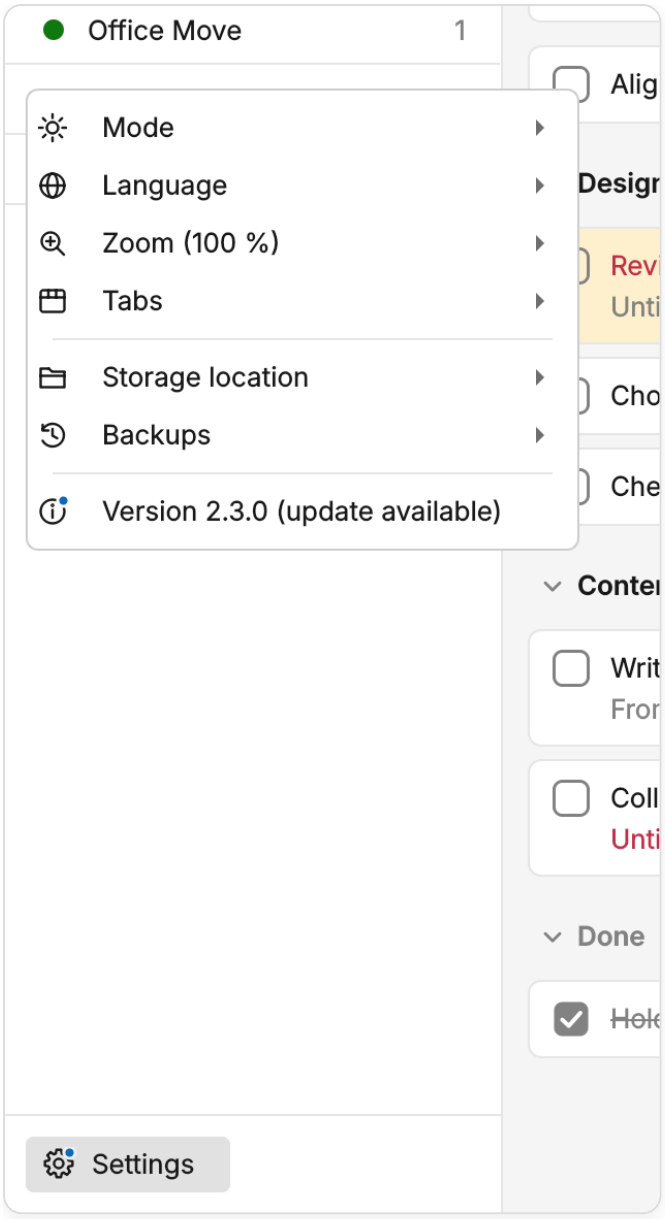
## Settings

- **Mode**: **Same as Windows**, **Light** or **Dark**.
- **Language**: Deutsch or English.
- **Zoom**: makes everything larger or smaller, also with `Ctrl` + `+`, `Ctrl` + `-`, `Ctrl` + `0` or `Ctrl` and the mouse wheel.
- **Tabs**: shows or hides **Todos**, **Notes** and **Links**. Hidden tabs keep their entries. At least one tab stays, and with only one tab the tab row disappears.
- **Storage location** and **Backups**: see the previous chapters.
- The installed version is shown at the bottom of the menu.

Once per start ProjectDesk looks on GitHub whether a newer version exists. If so, a blue bar says **Update available** once and the gear of **Settings** gets a blue dot. The version line at the bottom of the menu then shows **(update available)**, a click opens the download page with the new setup. The dot stays until the new version is installed. Without an internet connection nothing happens.




Settings, Tabs




A newer version in the settings

# Keyboard Shortcuts

| ACTION | KEYS |
| --- | --- |
| Add entry from the input field | Enter |
| Rename the selected entry | Double-click or F2 |
| Cancel renaming | Esc |
| Delete the selected entries or project | Delete |
| Undo | Ctrl + Z |
| Redo | Ctrl + Y or Ctrl + Shift + Z |
| Add an entry to the selection | Ctrl +click |
| Select a range | Shift +click |
| Select all entries of the tab | Ctrl + A |
| Clear the selection | Esc |
| Paste attachments, screenshots and images | Ctrl + V |
| Bold, italic, underline | Ctrl + B, Ctrl + I, Ctrl + U |
| List line one level in or out | Tab, Shift + Tab |
| Zoom in, zoom out, reset | Ctrl + +, Ctrl + -, Ctrl + 0 |